# THE ASSURANCE OF SALVATION

CHRISTIAN TEACHING NOTES

**Lesson aim:** To understand the meaning of salvation, develop confidence in Christ, and recognise the transformation that should take place in the life of a believer.

## 1. INTRODUCTION

### Meaning of assurance

Assurance means being certain, without doubt or fear. We should not doubt the salvation that comes from the Lord.

The word **Lord** means ruler or master. Therefore, we must understand that Jesus is our Saviour and the Ruler of our lives. Those who recognise Jesus as the Lord of their lives have accepted to submit themselves under the authority of Christ.

**Matthew 11:29**

> *"Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls."*

This means that we have accepted to be guided by Jesus, to listen to Him and to follow His instructions. We are true disciples who continually learn at the feet of Jesus.

The Lordship of Jesus is founded on love and genuine relationships. God loves us beyond measure. What enables us to do the will of God is our love for Him.

**John 14:15**

> *"If ye love me, keep my commandments."*

Jesus leads us willingly, not by force. **Willingness** means making a sincere decision from the heart to follow Jesus without pressure or compulsion.

Doubt is an enemy of faith.

**Matthew 14:31**

> *"And immediately Jesus stretched forth his hand, and caught him, and said unto him, O thou of little faith, wherefore didst thou doubt?"*

We must believe that we are saved and that Jesus has forgiven our sins. Those who have been redeemed are courageous people. They have confidence that they will complete their journey of salvation because God is with them.

**Matthew 1:23**

*“Behold, a virgin shall be with child, and shall bring forth a son, and they shall call his name Emmanuel, which being interpreted is, God with us.”*

## 2. WHAT IS SALVATION?

Salvation is the state of being rescued or transferred from danger.

**Colossians 1:13–14**

*“Who hath delivered us from the power of darkness, and hath translated us into the kingdom of his dear Son: In whom we have redemption through his blood, even the forgiveness of sins.”*

There is a place from which Jesus has rescued us. This clearly shows that without God's help, we could not have escaped.

Salvation is a transformation. It is a new life in Christ through the forgiveness of sins. When there is no change in the life of a believer, it raises a serious question about whether that person has truly encountered Jesus.

**2 Corinthians 5:17**

*“Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, all things are become new.”*

## 3. CHARACTERISTICS OF A NEW CREATURE

A person who receives Jesus Christ experiences changes in three major areas:

1. New appearance
2. New behaviour
3. New thoughts

### A. NEW APPEARANCE

A new appearance means looking different from the way we looked before receiving Jesus Christ. Areas where a person may experience changes include dressing, walking and speaking.

### 1. Dressing

Clothing is part of a person's identity and may reflect their character and occupation. As children of God, we should dress in a decent and respectful manner that covers our bodies appropriately.

**1 Thessalonians 4:4–5**

*“That every one of you should know how to possess his vessel in sanctification and honour; not in the lust of concupiscence, even as the Gentiles which know not God.”*

We should wear clothes that reflect holiness, dignity and respect for our bodies.

### 2. Walking

Walking is the movement of the body from one place to another by taking steps with our feet. As Christians, we should walk with confidence and without fear, like soldiers of the Lord. Our conduct should reflect Christ wherever we go. When people meet us, they should see Jesus through our lives.

### 3. Speaking

Speaking means expressing words through our mouths. We should ask ourselves: When we speak to people, what kind of words do we use? Are our words meant to build others up or destroy them? What message do we share when we meet people who do not know God?

We should tell people about Jesus and the hope we have in Him. The message about Jesus is the message of God's love, which is the Gospel. Our hope in Jesus Christ is the resurrection and eternal life.

### B. NEW BEHAVIOUR

New behaviour means having new habits and conduct that are different from those we had before receiving salvation.

**Example:** Before receiving Jesus, a person might use lies as a way of defending themselves. However, after receiving Jesus, that person chooses to speak the truth, even when telling the truth may bring personal difficulties.

A Christian should demonstrate Christ-like character through honesty, love, forgiveness, humility and obedience.

### C. NEW THOUGHTS

When we receive salvation, we are not only changed in our behaviour; our minds and ways of thinking are also transformed.

**Romans 12:2**

> *"And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind, that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God."*

When our minds are renewed:

1. We begin to think about the Kingdom of God and His righteousness.
2. We develop the ability to distinguish between good and evil.
3. We begin to think about how to bring people to Jesus.
4. We develop a desire to make other people disciples of Christ.

This is part of God's mission in sending Jesus into the world: to bring salvation to humanity and reconcile people to God.

## 4. CONCLUSION

The assurance of salvation means having confidence that Jesus Christ has saved us, forgiven our sins and given us a new life. A true encounter with Jesus should produce transformation in our appearance, behaviour and thoughts.

As Christians, we should:

- Trust Jesus without doubt.
- Submit ourselves to His authority.
- Love Him and obey His commandments.
- Live holy and transformed lives.
- Share the Gospel with others.
- Make disciples of Jesus Christ.

Our confidence is not in our own strength, but in Jesus Christ, who saves us and remains with us throughout our journey of faith.

## 5. KEY BIBLE REFERENCES

| Bible reference | Main teaching |
|---|---|
| Matthew 11:29 | Submission to Jesus |
| John 14:15 | Love and obedience |
| Matthew 14:31 | Faith instead of doubt |
| Matthew 1:23 | God is with us |
| Colossians 1:13–14 | Deliverance and forgiveness |
| 2 Corinthians 5:17 | Becoming a new creature |
| 1 Thessalonians 4:4–5 | Holiness and honour |
| Romans 12:2 | Renewal of the mind |

## MEMORY VERSE

**2 Corinthians 5:17**

**“Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, all things are become new.”**

**END OF LESSON**